A quick homemade version of pesto is spooned on top of this fava bean soup, giving it extra flavor, color, and texture—perfect for serving at a dinner party.

fava bean soup with arugula pesto

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 20 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
SOUP AND PESTO SEPARATELY

2 tbsp olive oil
1 onion, chopped
2 celery ribs, halved lengthwise, sliced
2 garlic cloves, chopped
4 slices prosciutto, chopped
pinch crushed hot red pepper flakes
handful basil leaves, shredded
1 quart (1 liter) vegetable or chicken stock
1¾oz (50g) spaghetti, broken into pieces
1 x 14oz (400g) can fava beans, drained

for the pesto
scant 1oz (25g) arugula, very finely chopped
2 tbsp very finely chopped basil
scant 1oz (25g) Parmesan cheese, grated
scant 1oz (25g) pine nuts, toasted, very finely chopped
1 small garlic clove, finely chopped
3 tbsp olive oil
salt and freshly ground back pepper

1 Heat the oil for the soup in a large saucepan. Add the onion and celery and cook for 4–5 minutes until the onion is soft but not brown. Add the garlic and cook for 1 minute. Stir in the prosciutto and pepper flakes and cook another 1–2 minutes until the prosciutto is starting to crisp. Stir in the basil, stock, and spaghetti. Bring to a boil. Simmer for about 10 minutes or until the spaghetti is *al dente*. Add the fava beans and warm through.

2 Spoon 3 ladlefuls of the soup into a food processor or blender and process until smooth. Stir it back into the rest of the soup and season with salt and pepper to taste.

3 Mix all the ingredients for the pesto together in a bowl or coarsely chop in a small blender. Season it with pepper and a pinch of salt. Reheat the soup and serve with a spoonful of pesto on top.